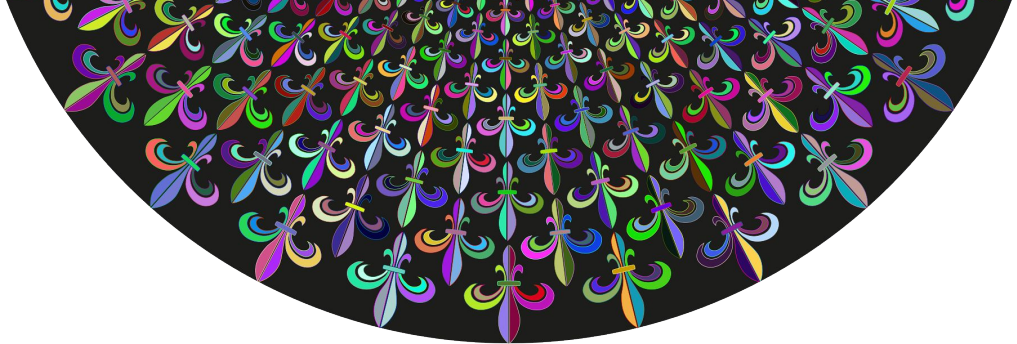




NewsImages 2026

Lucien Heitz, University of Zurich

Bruno N. Sotic, University of Amsterdam

Qi Bi, Utrecht University

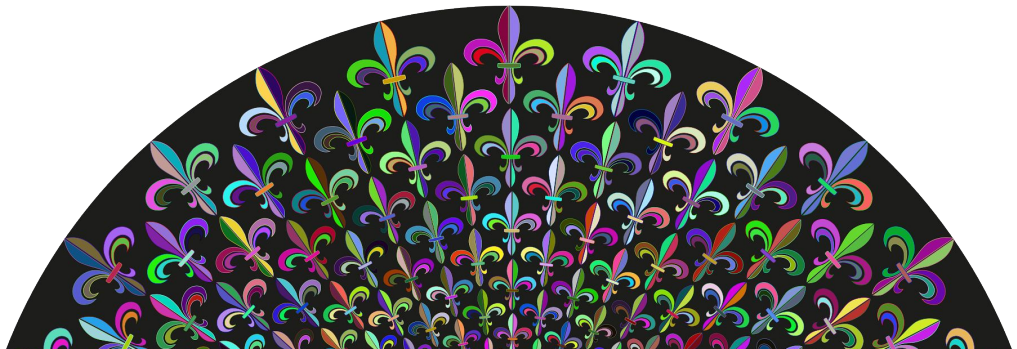
Luca Rossetto, Dublin City University

Ali A. Katamjani, Utrecht University,

Bram Bakker, Radboud University Nijmegen

Jaap Kamps, University of Amsterdam

MediaEval Workshop
15-16 June 2026,
Amsterdam, Netherlands
and Online



Bilston school takes trip down memory lane as staff and pupils celebrate 90th anniversary.



Background and Motivation

- Images drive engagements with news
- Headline-image relation not necessarily literal
- Large design space for recommending images
- Rapid progress in retrieval and generative models



Data

- 15,000+ news headlines with images
- Sourced from the web (GDELT/MIND) and print
 - Title: “Global stocks, dollar gain as UK ...”
 - Article (URL): <https://www.marketscreener.com/...>
 - Image: original or scan (only for training)



Approaches

- SOTA VLM-based generative approaches
- Hybrid approaches based on category
- Exploration of art styles and subjects



Evaluation and Metrics

- Online evaluation with experts & non-experts
- 5-point Likert scale to rate headline-image fit
- Evaluation criterion is average fit for a run



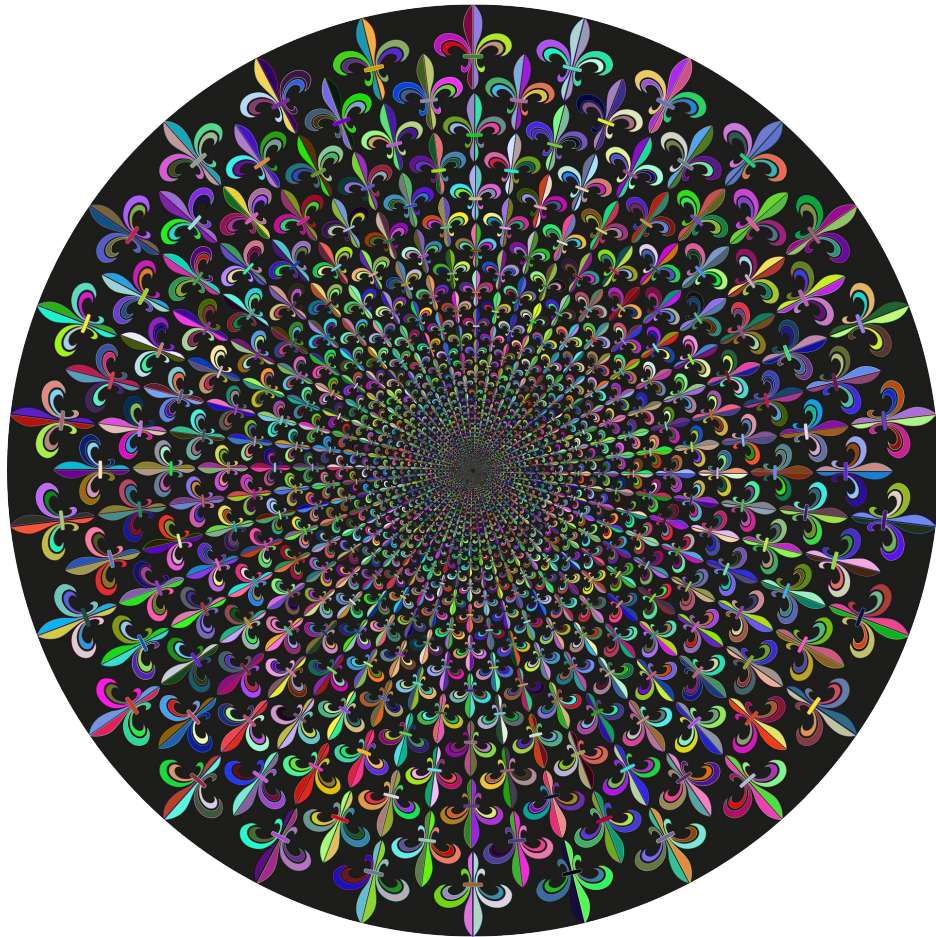
Leaderboard

TEAM	APPROACH	SCORE
CERTH-ITI	Run 6	3.616
FAST-MS	RealVisXL	3.209
TEAM-A++	SDXL-CFT	3.041
NewsWeavers	Qwen 3B Plan Prompt Zero Shot FLUX	2.907
Originals	Editorial Baseline	2.880

Results

- Automated approaches can outperform editors
- Personal preferences matter, no “right” answer
- Human oversight and quality control





Questions?